

Word family: **sincere / sincerely / sincerity / insincere / insincerely / insincerity**

Base word: sincere

Part of speech: mainly **adjective**

Related forms:

* **sincere** (adj.) — 真誠的；誠懇的

* **sincerely** (adv.) — 真誠地；誠懇地

* **sincerity** (n.) — 真誠；誠意

* **insincere** (adj.) — 不真誠的；虛假的

* **insincerely** (adv.) — 不真誠地

* **insincerity** (n.) — 不真誠；虛情假意

Useful expressions / extensions:

* **a sincere apology**

* **sincere thanks**

* **sincere regret**

* **sincere concern**

* **sincere belief**

* **sincerely apologise**

* **sincerely hope**

* **sincerely believe**

* **the sincerity of**

* **with sincerity**

* **question someone's sincerity**

* **doubt someone's sincerity**

* **prove / show sincerity**

* **insincere apology**

* **sound insincere**

Meaning in this passage

> What stayed with me was not just the apology itself, but the **sincerity behind it**.

Here, **sincerity** means:

the quality of genuinely meaning what you say or do, rather than pretending — 真誠；誠意；真心

The speaker valued Kevin's apology because it did not sound forced, defensive, or merely polite. Kevin genuinely accepted that he had done wrong.

****中文翻譯：****

讓我一直記得的，不只是那一句道歉本身，而是它背後的****真誠 / 誠意****。

So here:

****sincerity = 說話或行為背後真心、誠懇而沒有虛假的態度****

1. ****sincerity (真誠；誠意) — 真誠；誠懇****

This is the exact sense used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> What stayed with me was the ****sincerity behind the apology****.

讓我一直記得的是那次道歉背後的****真誠****。

Practice 2

> I could hear the ****sincerity**** in her voice.

我能從她的聲音中聽出****真誠****。

Practice 3

> His ****sincerity**** made the apology easier to accept.

他的****誠意****令那次道歉更容易被接受。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****sincerity = 真心相信、感受或有意表達某件事，而不是假裝或敷衍的品質****

2. ****the sincerity behind something — 某事背後的真誠 / 誠意****

Highly relevant to your passage.

Practice 1

> I appreciated the ****sincerity behind his words****.

我欣賞他說話背後的****真誠****。

Practice 2

> The gift was simple, but the **sincerity** behind it made it meaningful.

禮物很簡單，但背後的**心意和真誠**令它很有意義。

MCQ-ready definition:

the sincerity behind X = X 所表達出的真心和誠意

3. **with sincerity** — 真誠地；帶着誠意

Practice 1

> He spoke **with sincerity**.

他說話時很**真誠**。

Practice 2

> The apology was delivered **with sincerity**.

那次道歉是帶着**誠意**作出的。

MCQ-ready definition:

with sincerity = 以真心、誠懇而不虛假的態度

4. **show sincerity** — 表現誠意

Practice 1

> He **showed sincerity** by accepting responsibility.

他透過承擔責任**表現出誠意**。

Practice 2

> Actions often **show sincerity** better than words.

行動往往比說話更能**顯示真誠**。

MCQ-ready definition:

****show sincerity = 透過說話或行動讓別人看出自己是真心的****

5. ****prove your sincerity — 證明自己的誠意****

Practice 1

> He tried to ****prove his sincerity**** through his actions.

他試圖透過行動****證明自己的誠意****。

Practice 2

> It takes time to ****prove your sincerity****.

要****證明自己的真心****需要時間。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****prove your sincerity = 用行動或證據令人相信你的態度是真誠的****

6. ****question someone's sincerity — 質疑某人的誠意****

Practice 1

> Some people ****questioned his sincerity****.

有些人****質疑他的誠意****。

Practice 2

> I had no reason to ****question her sincerity****.

我沒有理由****懷疑她是否真心****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****question someone's sincerity = 懷疑某人是否真的真心，而不是假裝****

7. ****doubt someone's sincerity — 懷疑某人的真誠****

Practice 1

> She **doubted the sincerity of his apology**.

她懷疑他的道歉是否**真誠**。

Practice 2

> Nobody **doubted his sincerity**.

沒有人**懷疑他的誠意**。

MCQ-ready definition:

doubt someone's sincerity = 不確定某人的說話、感受或承諾是否真心

8. **sincere** (真誠的 ; 誠懇的) — 真誠的

Core adjective.

Practice 1

> He gave me a **sincere apology**.

他向我作出了**真誠的道歉**。

Practice 2

> Her concern seemed **sincere**.

她的關心看起來很**真誠**。

MCQ-ready definition:

sincere = genuinely meant or felt, without pretending

中文 :

出於真心，而不是假裝、敷衍或做表面功夫的

9. **a sincere apology** — 真誠的道歉

Very important for your passage.

Practice 1

> A **sincere apology** can rebuild trust.

真誠的道歉可以重建信任。

Practice 2

> He offered a **sincere apology** for embarrassing me.

他為令我難堪作出了**真誠的道歉**。

MCQ-ready definition:

sincere apology = 真心承認錯誤並表達後悔，而不是只為形式而道歉

10. **sincere thanks** — 衷心感謝

Practice 1

> Please accept my **sincere thanks**.

請接受我**衷心的感謝**。

Practice 2

> She expressed her **sincere thanks** to the team.

她向團隊表達**真誠謝意**。

MCQ-ready definition:

sincere thanks = 真心而誠懇的感謝

11. **sincere regret** — 真誠的遺憾 / 悔意

Practice 1

> He expressed **sincere regret** for his actions.

他對自己的行為表達**真誠的悔意**。

Practice 2

> The statement showed **sincere regret**.

那份聲明顯示出**真誠的遺憾**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****sincere regret = 真心對某件事感到後悔或遺憾****

12. ****sincere concern — 真切的關心****

Practice 1

> She showed ****sincere concern**** for his health.

她對他的健康表現出****真切關心****。

Practice 2

> His concern seemed completely ****sincere****.

他的關心看起來完全是****真心的****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****sincere concern = 出於真心而對某人或某事感到關心****

13. ****sincere belief — 真誠相信；真心持有的信念****

Practice 1

> It was his ****sincere belief**** that the plan would work.

他****真心相信****那個計劃會成功。

Practice 2

> She expressed a ****sincere belief**** in the value of education.

她真誠表達自己對教育價值的****信念****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****sincere belief = 某人真正相信，而非為迎合別人而聲稱相信的觀點****

14. ****sincerely (真誠地) — 真誠地；誠懇地****

Practice 1

> He **sincerely apologised**.

他**真誠地道歉**。

Practice 2

> I **sincerely thank you** for your help.

我**衷心感謝**你的幫忙。

MCQ-ready definition:

sincerely = 以真心、誠懇而非虛假的方式

15. **sincerely apologise — 真誠道歉**

Practice 1

> I **sincerely apologise** for what happened.

我為發生的事**真誠致歉**。

Practice 2

> He **sincerely apologised** to the whole group.

他向全組人**真心道歉**。

MCQ-ready definition:

sincerely apologise = 真心承認錯誤並表達歉意

16. **sincerely hope — 衷心希望**

Practice 1

> I **sincerely hope** things improve.

我**衷心希望**事情會改善。

Practice 2

> We **sincerely hope** you enjoy the event.

我們**真心希望**你享受這次活動。

MCQ-ready definition:

sincerely hope = 真心而非客套地希望某件事發生

17. **sincerely believe — 真心相信**

Practice 1

> I **sincerely believe** he learned from the mistake.

我**真心相信**他從錯誤中學到了東西。

Practice 2

> She **sincerely believed** she was doing the right thing.

她**真心相信**自己做的是對的。

MCQ-ready definition:

sincerely believe = 真正持有某個信念，而不是假裝相信

18. **Yours sincerely — 謹啟 / 敬上 (書信結尾)**

A fixed correspondence use, especially BrE.

Practice 1

> The letter ended with **“Yours sincerely.”**

那封信以 **“Yours sincerely”** 作結。

Practice 2

> In traditional British correspondence, **Yours sincerely** is commonly used when the recipient is addressed by name.

在傳統英式書信格式中，如果知道收件人的姓名，常以 **Yours sincerely** 作結。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****Yours sincerely = 正式書信中的結尾敬語****

This is a fixed formula and does ****not**** literally mean the writer is emphasizing emotional sincerity every time.

19. ****insincere — 不真誠的；虛假的****

Important opposite.

Practice 1

> The apology sounded ****insincere****.

那次道歉聽起來很****不真誠****。

Practice 2

> His smile seemed ****insincere****.

他的笑容看起來有點****虛假****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****insincere = 表面上表達某種感情或態度，但實際上並不真心****

20. ****insincere apology — 敷衍 / 不真誠的道歉****

Practice 1

> An ****insincere apology**** can make things worse.

一個****不真誠的道歉****反而可能令事情更糟。

Practice 2

> She rejected what she felt was an ****insincere apology****.

她覺得那次道歉很****敷衍、不真心****，所以不接受。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****insincere apology = 不是出於真心，可能只是為了形式、壓力或避免後果而作出的道歉****

21. **insincerely** — 不真誠地；敷衍地

Practice 1

> He apologised **insincerely**.

他**敷衍地道歉**。

Practice 2

> She smiled **insincerely** and changed the subject.

她**不真誠地笑了一下**，便轉換話題。

MCQ-ready definition:

insincerely = 以不是真心、表面應付的方式

22. **insincerity** — 不真誠；虛情假意

Practice 1

> People quickly noticed the **insincerity** in his apology.

人們很快便察覺他道歉中的**不真誠**。

Practice 2

> Her tone suggested **insincerity**.

她的語氣令人感到有點**虛情假意**。

MCQ-ready definition:

insincerity = 缺乏真心或誠意的特質

23. **sincerity of purpose** — 目標 / 意圖的真誠

A more formal expression.

Practice 1

> Nobody doubted her ****sincerity of purpose****.

沒有人懷疑她做這件事的****真誠意圖****。

Practice 2

> His actions demonstrated ****sincerity of purpose****.

他的行動顯示出他是****真心想把事情做好****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****sincerity of purpose = 對自己的目標或意圖是真心認真的，而不是裝模作樣****

Important distinction 1: ****sincere vs honest****

****sincere****

you genuinely mean what you say or feel.

****honest****

you tell the truth and do not deceive.

Someone can be:

> sincere but mistaken

真心，但錯了

For example:

> He sincerely believed I had not uploaded the file.

他當時可能真的相信我沒有上傳。

That does not mean his belief was factually correct.

So:

****sincerity concerns genuineness****

****honesty concerns truthfulness****

Important distinction 2: **sincerity vs truth**

This is a crucial distinction.

A statement can be **sincere but false**.

> “I sincerely thought the file was missing.”

The speaker may genuinely believe this, even if the file was actually there.

So:

sincere ≠ necessarily correct

Important distinction 3: **sincere vs genuine**

Very close.

sincere

especially describes feelings, words, apologies, intentions.

genuine

broader: truly what it claims to be; authentic.

> sincere apology

> 真誠道歉

> genuine leather

> 真皮

For emotions, they overlap strongly:

> sincere concern

> genuine concern

both = 真心關心

Important distinction 4: **sincere vs heartfelt**

sincere

genuinely meant.

heartfelt

strongly and deeply felt emotionally.

> sincere apology

真誠道歉

> heartfelt apology

發自內心、感情很深的道歉

Heartfelt is often warmer and more emotional.

Important distinction 5: **sincere vs serious**

sincere

genuine.

**serious

not joking; important; committed.

> a sincere apology

真心道歉

> a serious apology

less standard; may suggest the person is speaking seriously.

Someone can be serious without being sincere.

Important distinction 6: **sincerity vs politeness**

**politeness

socially appropriate manners.

sincerity

genuine feeling.

Someone can say:

> "I'm terribly sorry."

very politely but without real sincerity.

In your passage, the speaker values Kevin's **sincerity**, not merely his manners.

Important distinction 7: **sincerity vs apology**

apology

the act/words of saying sorry.

sincerity

the genuine feeling behind those words.

This is exactly the contrast in your passage:

> not just **the apology itself**

> but **the sincerity behind it**

Important distinction 8: **sincere vs apologetic**

sincere

genuine.

apologetic

showing that you feel sorry.

A person may look apologetic, but the listener may still question whether the apology is sincere.

Important distinction 9: ****sincere apology vs convincing apology****

****sincere****

actually genuine.

****convincing****

successfully makes others believe it.

A sincere apology may sound awkward but still be genuine.

A polished apology may sound convincing but not necessarily be sincere.

Important distinction 10: ****insincere vs dishonest****

****insincere****

feelings/attitude are not genuine.

****dishonest****

actively deceptive or untruthful.

An insincere compliment may be socially polite without containing a direct factual lie.

Important distinction 11: ****sincerely vs genuinely****

They overlap heavily.

****sincerely****

often used with:

* apologise

* hope

* thank

* believe

****genuinely****

broader everyday intensifier of authentic feeling:

- * genuinely surprised
- * genuinely interested

In your passage, either could work:

- > sincerely apologised
- > genuinely apologised

Important distinction 12: **sincerity vs earnestness**

sincerity

genuine feeling/intention.

earnestness

serious, intense commitment or seriousness.

Someone may be sincere but relaxed; **earnest** often sounds more intensely serious.

Important distinction 13: **sincerity is usually uncountable**

Normally:

- > his sincerity
- > the sincerity of the apology

Not usually:

- > **a sincerity** ❌

It describes a quality rather than a countable object.

Family-extension note

The **sincere** family has one strong semantic core:

what is expressed outwardly matches what is genuinely felt or intended inwardly

That produces:

1. **adjective**

- * sincere apology
- * sincere thanks
- * sincere concern

2. **adverb**

- * sincerely apologise
- * sincerely hope

3. **noun**

- * sincerity
- * sincerity behind the apology

4. **negative family**

- * insincere
- * insincerely
- * insincerity

The central contrast is:

sincere = 真心如此

VS

insincere = 表面如此，但內心不是真的如此

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea
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sincerity	真誠；誠意	genuineness
sincerity behind X	X 背後的真誠	genuine intention
with sincerity	真誠地	genuine manner
show sincerity	表現誠意	demonstrate genuineness
prove sincerity	證明誠意	establish genuineness
question sincerity	質疑誠意	doubt genuineness
sincere	真誠的	genuinely meant
sincere apology	真誠道歉	genuine regret

sincere thanks	衷心感謝	genuine gratitude	
sincere regret	真誠悔意	genuine regret	
sincere concern	真切關心	genuine concern	
sincere belief	真心信念	genuinely held belief	
sincerely	真誠地	genuine manner	
sincerely apologise	真誠道歉	genuine apology	
sincerely hope	衷心希望	genuine hope	
sincerely believe	真心相信	genuine belief	
Yours sincerely	謹啟 / 敬上	letter closing	
insincere	不真誠的	not genuine	
insincere apology	敷衍 / 不真誠的道歉	false apology	
insincerely	不真誠地	false manner	
insincerity	不真誠；虛情假意	lack of genuineness	

For your original sentence

> What stayed with me was not just the apology itself, but the **sincerity behind it**.

Here:

sincerity = Kevin 並不是只為了把事情平息而隨口說 sorry，而是真的承認自己做錯、理解對方受傷的原因，並真心感到抱歉

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 讓我一直記得的，不只是那一句道歉本身，而是它背後的**真誠 / 誠意**。

The key contrast is:

> **apology** = 說了甚麼、做了甚麼

> **sincerity** = 背後是否真心

And that distinction is exactly why the apology mattered so much to the speaker.